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Title: Long-Term Company Loyalty Is No Longer Necessary for Career Success

[Topic: What is one workplace expectation that you think is no longer relevant today? Give three reasons to explain your choice.]

INTRODUCTION

The World Economic Forum (WEF) stated that ["The linear ladder – one company, regular promotions, steady climb – is fading."](#) This suggests that long-term company loyalty is no longer an essential workplace expectation today. In the past, work success often meant staying with a company for 10 to 20 years to gain promotions and job stability. However, this path is less realistic today, as **WEF's** report also found that [39% of workers' core skills will change by 2030](#), showing that adaptability matters more than simply staying with one company. As a polytechnic student preparing to enter the workforce, I find this topic crucial to understanding how to stay relevant and competitive in the workforce. I believe long-term loyalty to a company is an outdated workplace expectation, as workers can build transferable skills, seek fair rewards, and explore non-linear paths.

DISCUSSION

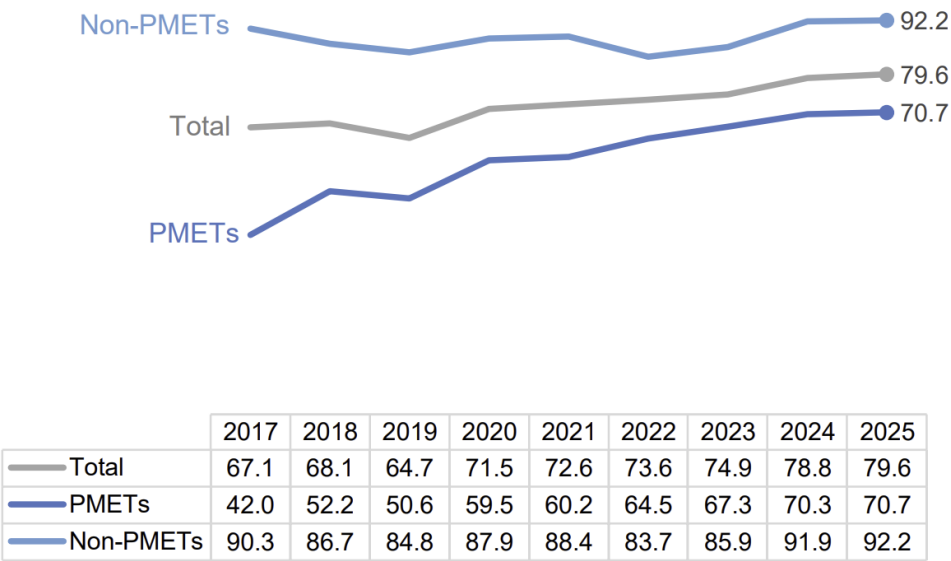
Job Mobility Builds Better Skills

Firstly, the expectation of staying loyal to one company is less necessary as job mobility helps workers develop broader skills. Staying loyal to a company limited employees to mastering one skillset, while working in different companies gives them more experience and skills through the exposure of different teams they meet, projects they do, and different problem-solving methods.

[MOM's Job Vacancies 2025 report found that academic qualifications were not the main determinant for 79.6% of vacancies](#), showing that employers value skills and experience. This is especially true in the cybersecurity field, where someone who stays in one company may only learn to secure that organisation's systems and network environment, whereas someone who works or interns in multiple companies is exposed

to different security risks, tools, and policies. These varied experiences can make workers more attractive to employers.

Chart 5: Proportion of Job Vacancies For Which Academic Qualifications Were Not The Main Consideration (%)



Source: Job Vacancy Survey, Manpower Research & Statistics Department, MOM

Figure 1. MOM’s Job Vacancies 2025 report shows that academic qualifications were not the main determinant for 79.6% of vacancies, suggesting that practical skills are increasingly valued.

Photo credit: [Ministry of Manpower Singapore Job Vacancies 2025 Report](#)

Loyalty Does Not Guarantee Rewards

Secondly, long-term loyalty to a company does not always guarantee benefits. In the past, loyalty was often linked to promotions and job security. However, workers today may still face limited salary growth and heavier workloads. An article published by [Duke Today](#) highlighted how [managers were more likely to assign unpaid work to loyal employees because they were seen as more likely to accept it](#). This shows that loyalty can create higher expectations instead of fair rewards. With this knowledge, employees may not view loyalty as a safe career strategy. Based on my observations, even professionals like lecturers may leave organisations for better career opportunities, salary progression, or healthier work environments. This shows that employees may choose workplaces that recognise their value, rather than staying loyal without

guaranteed advancement. Hence, long-term loyalty is no longer a workplace expectation that is essential today.

Support for Non-Linear Careers

Lastly, long-term company loyalty is less necessary as society today supports non-linear careers. Digital platforms, freelancing, and entrepreneurship help to build income and personal brands outside of traditional employment, no longer needing to follow the fixed path of climbing up the corporate ladder.

For example, [MySkillsFuture](#) supports Singaporeans in continuous learning, career switching, and skills upgrading throughout their lives. This shows that workers are encouraged to keep adapting instead of staying permanently in one company. Content creators such as [DRZY](#) also show that individuals today can build personal brands and income via social media posts and livestreams. I have observed on social media that many young adults pursue freelancing, content creation, or online work alongside their studies. This makes long-term company loyalty less necessary as a workplace expectation as career success can come from multiple pathways, not just one employer.

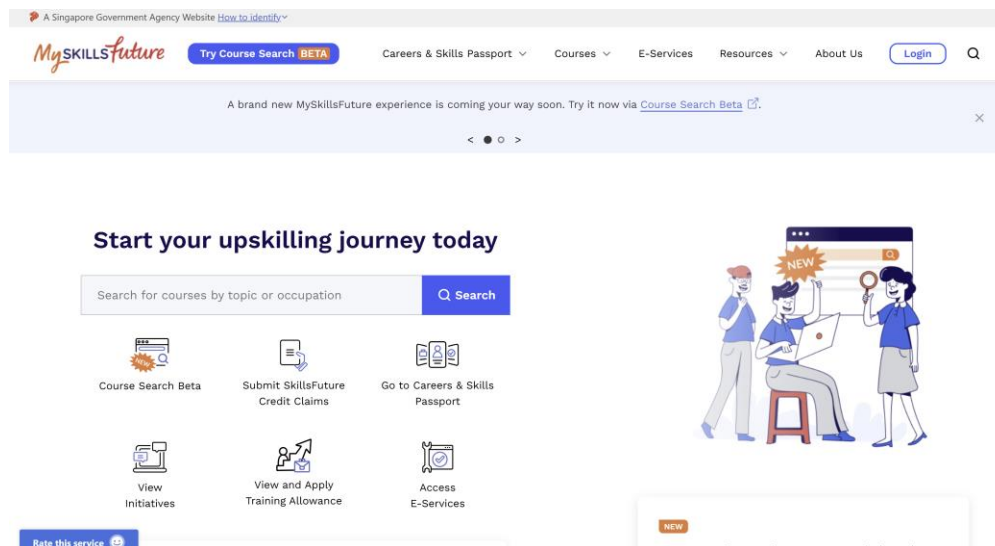


Figure 2. MySkillsFuture encourages lifelong learning, skills upgrading, and career switching, showing that modern workers are supported in building flexible, non-linear career paths.

Photo Credit: [MySkillsFuture Singapore](#)

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, long-term company loyalty is no longer a workplace expectation that is necessary. Job mobility builds adaptable skills, while loyalty does not always guarantee fair rewards, and society today supports more flexible career paths. This does not mean loyalty is worthless, but employees should develop relevant skills, seek fair opportunities, and remain open to different pathways. To find out more, join the TP Talks seminar series on 11 August 2026, at 9am in TP's Auditorium 3.

Word Count: 646

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